Life sciences: nutrients and digestion

Middle school - Year 4 (4AM) | Concept sheet + questions + answers

How to use this sheet

Read the lesson, try each exercise without the answer key, then correct your work. These original exercises are for practice and should be checked against your teacher instructions.

1. Food and nutrients

Food provides matter and energy. Nutrient groups include carbohydrates, lipids, proteins, vitamins, mineral salts and water. A balanced diet varies with age, activity and individual needs.

2. Digestion

Digestion transforms food into small nutrients that can pass through the intestinal wall. The digestive tract includes mouth, oesophagus, stomach, small intestine and large intestine.

3. Absorption and cells

Most nutrient absorption occurs in the small intestine. Nutrients enter the blood (some lipids also enter lymph) and travel to organs and cells. Cells use nutrients for energy, growth and repair.

4. Questions

1) Name three nutrient groups. 2) Where does most absorption occur? 3) Explain digestion vs absorption. 4) Why is water important? 5) Put in order: small intestine, mouth, stomach, oesophagus.

5. Answer key